

GAURI BHAWARKAR

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DATA GOVERNANCE MANAGER

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Governance professional with 6+ years of progressive experience leading enterprise governance programs at scale in financial services. Currently operating at full manager scope at CIBC, owning a multi-segment portfolio, driving compliance programs, managing executive stakeholder relationships, and building team capability from the ground up. Seeking a managerial role to formalize the leadership scope already being delivered.

LEADERSHIP AND MANAGEMENT CAPABILITIES

Program Ownership: Enterprise Governance Program Design, Portfolio Management, Compliance Delivery, Change Management, Implementation to BAU Transitions

Executive Communication: Board-level Materials Preparation, Senior Leadership Updates, Risk Forum Representation, Business and Technical Translation

People Leadership: Custodian and Steward Onboarding, Training Program Design and Delivery, Analyst Mentorship, Cross-functional Team Leadership, Governance Forums Facilitation

Governance Expertise: CDE Management, Metadata and Cataloging, Privacy and PII Classification, Audit Readiness, DCAM Maturity, Stewardship Models

Tools and Analytics: Collibra (Certified), Power BI, Power Automate, Informatica, Tableau, JIRA, Confluence, Smartsheet, Visio

Methodologies: Agile / Scrum (CSPO), Six Sigma Green Belt, Design Thinking, Risk and Issue Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Governance Analyst

September 2023 – Present

CIBC US | Chicago, IL (Remote)

Independently leading the governance program across Finance (9 sub-segments), Commercial Banking, and US Personal, Private and Digital Banking, with full accountability for governance strategy, compliance, stakeholder relationships, and team capability building. Scope and responsibilities are equivalent to a Data Governance Manager.

Program Ownership and Delivery

- Own end-to-end governance accountability for 210 core reports, 168 risk metrics, and approximately 15,000 CDEs across three practice areas, representing the largest governance portfolio in the US region.
- Led the full governance implementation lifecycle across all three practice areas, building training programs, self-service tooling, and accountability structures that enabled a successful transition to BAU in November 2024.
- Led enterprise compliance recovery program that drove governance compliance from under 40% to over 90% within approximately 10 months, involving process redesign, control remediation, and sustained executive reporting.
- Currently leading the initiation of a new critical operations governance program at CIBC US, the first of its kind for the bank, building the governance framework from the ground up.
- Contributed to the company-wide DCAM maturity assessment that achieved a Level 4 Defined rating, requiring sustained cross-functional program leadership across multiple business units.

Executive Communication and Stakeholder Management

- Prepare governance presentations and board-level materials for senior leadership at board meetings and quarterly US Data Head risk forums, translating complex program data into executive-level narratives.
- Represent the DG team at quarterly risk meetings with the US Data Head, presenting program progress, open issues, and incidents below threshold on behalf of the team.
- Manage governance delivery and accountability across approximately 40 stakeholders including data custodians, data owners, and senior business leaders across Finance, Commercial Banking, and Retail Banking.
- Lead monthly DMO forums and weekly DG team forums, setting agenda, resolving escalations, and driving enterprise alignment on governance priorities and program direction.
- Coordinate 2 to 3 internal and regulatory audits annually, managing evidence, remediation timelines, and stakeholder communications as the DG program lead.

Team Leadership and Enablement

- Onboarded and trained 15 to 20 data custodians and stewards across all portfolio segments on their data governance roles and responsibilities, equipping them to self-service their governance obligations independently.
- Served as Training Head for the US Region, designing and delivering governance training programs for custodians, stewards, and segment leads, resulting in a 25% increase in policy awareness and data fluency.
- Mentor junior DG analysts on governance frameworks, tooling, and stakeholder engagement, supporting their development into independent contributors.

Governance Operations

- Reviewed 100% of governed assets against the bank's internal classification framework to identify and tag PII and sensitive data elements across all three practice areas.
- Designed Visio-based interdepartmental relationship maps adopted enterprise-wide, formalizing accountability structures and interaction models across all stakeholder groups.
- Built Power BI dashboards providing real-time visibility into issue resolution, intake pipeline, control gaps, and quality dimensions, enabling proactive and data-driven program management.
- Designed Power Automate workflows to automate catalog metadata updates, eliminating manual processes and improving data accuracy at scale.

Data and Analytics Consultant

June 2019 – May 2022

Infosys | Bangalore, India

Promoted from Associate Consultant to Senior Associate Consultant in July 2020. Led client-facing analytics and governance initiatives for global banking clients, managing full delivery lifecycles and cross-functional teams.

- Led AI/ML product development for a commercial banking client, contributing to a 55% improvement in profit margins through improved forecast accuracy and new revenue stream identification.
- Managed end-to-end delivery of an RPA automation initiative for a European bank, reducing FTE effort by 80% and transaction processing time by 50%. Acted as the primary liaison between business stakeholders and the technical delivery team.
- Mentored junior consultants on governance frameworks, agile delivery, and client engagement practices.
- Steered 3 agile SDLC projects end-to-end, gathering requirements, managing user story prioritization, and ensuring on-budget delivery for cross-functional teams.

Systems Engineer

July 2015 – July 2016

IBM | Bangalore, India

- Designed SQL-based data quality processes that reduced data duplication by 30% and built Tableau dashboards that improved senior stakeholder decision-making speed by 50%.

EDUCATION

MS, Business Analytics & Information Management

June 2022 – May 2023

Purdue University, Krannert School of Management | West Lafayette, IN

MBA in Marketing

August 2017 – April 2019

K J Somaiya Institute of Management | Mumbai, India

B.Tech in Computer Science Engineering

August 2011 – May 2015

Shri Guru Gobind Singhji Institute of Engineering and Technology | Nanded, India

CERTIFICATIONS

- Data Management Capability Assessment Model (DCAM) v3 — EDM Council
- Collibra Certified Data Steward (Collibra Ranger)
- Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) — Scrum Alliance
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner | Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Tableau Desktop Specialist
- INFORMS Certified Analytics Professional (CAP)
- Six Sigma Green Belt | Infosys Global Agile Certified